# Patrick Abdulmalik Marban Velez

**Atty. Patrick Abdulmalik Marban Velez** (Muslim name: **Abdulmalik**) is a Filipino lawyer, legal scholar, national security specialist, and bar association executive whose career cuts across three distinct worlds: the Philippine defense establishment, Islamic jurisprudence, and bar governance.

A multifaceted jurist, he is one of a rare few Filipino lawyers who holds credentials in both the regular Philippine court system and the Shari'ah courts, while simultaneously carrying a military commission as a **Lieutenant Colonel** in the **Philippine Marines.**

Born into a family where the law was a way of life, Velez grew up as the son of the late **Atty. Puro Velez** of the celebrated UP Law Batch 1958.

That legal inheritance shaped everything that followed: a Juris Doctor from the country's premier law school, a master's degree in national security, and a postgraduate qualification in Islamic Studies, all from the University of the Philippines system.

Since **October 2025,** he has served as the **National Executive Director** of the Integrated Bar of the Philippines (IBP), the country's mandatory organization for all licensed attorneys and the central institution of Philippine bar governance.

Beyond his administrative and government work, Velez is a committed advocate for the Bangsamoro community and Muslim Filipinos, championing the integration of Islamic legal perspectives into national legislation and pushing for the adoption of Artificial Intelligence in modernizing the Philippine legal profession.

His legacy phrase, drawn from his own philosophy, says it plainly: **"Excellence is a ladder, and service to the Ummah and the country must go hand in hand."**

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# Background

Patrick Abdulmalik Marban Velez did not stumble into law.

He was born into it.

His father, the late **Atty. Puro Velez,** was a member of the **University of the Philippines College of Law, Batch 1958**, one of the most distinguished graduating classes in Philippine legal history.

Growing up in a household where legal reasoning, public service, and respect for the rule of law were everyday conversations, Patrick developed a deep appreciation for the profession long before he ever stepped into a courtroom.

That upbringing set the stage for a journey that would eventually take him from the halls of the UP College of Law to the corridors of the Department of National Defense, from the United Nations to the executive offices of the Integrated Bar of the Philippines.

He joined the **UP Sigma Rho Fraternity** (Batch '87), a prestigious law fraternity known for shaping many of the country's most distinguished legal careers.

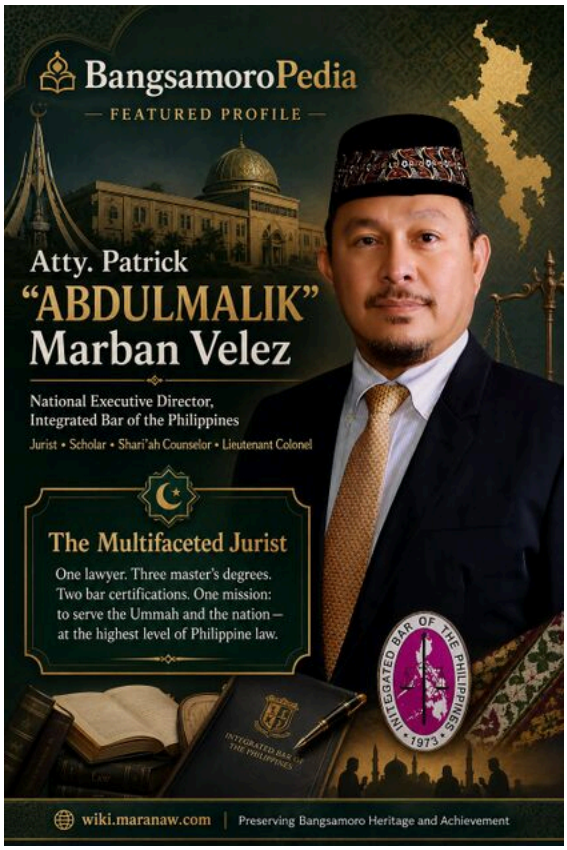
That fraternal formation, steeped in discipline, intellectual rigor, and peer excellence, would remain a cornerstone of his professional identity throughout his career.

As a Muslim Filipino, Velez also carries a cultural and spiritual identity that sets him apart in Philippine legal circles: the embrace of his Islamic faith as an active, professional asset rather than a private matter, expressed most tangibly in his decision to pursue formal Shari'ah qualifications alongside his mainstream legal career.

# Education

Velez didn't settle for one credential when three were possible.

**Atty. Patrick Abdulmalik Marban Velez**




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|---|---|
| **Muslim Name** | Abdulmalik |
| **Nationality** | Filipino |
| **Alma Mater** | University of the Philippines College of Law (JD, 1998)<br><br>National Defense College of the Philippines (MNSA, 2009) University of the Philippines Diliman (MAIS) |
| **Bar Admission** | Philippine Bar, 1999<br><br>Shari'ah Bar, 2024 |
| **Military Rank** | Lieutenant Colonel, Philippine Marines |
| **Occupation** | Lawyer, Legal Academic, National Security Expert, Bar Association Executive |
| **Known For** | National Executive Director, Integrated Bar of |

His academic profile is a trilogy: law, defense, and Islamic scholarship, each building on the last, and each from one of the Philippines' most respected institutions.

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| | the Philippines;<br><br>Shari'ah Bar Passer; AFP Modernization Program Point Person |
| **Law Firm** | Marcoleta Julian Reyes and Velez (MJRV) Law Offices (co-founded 2015) |
| **Fraternity** | UP Sigma Rho (Batch '87) |
| **Father** | Late Atty. Puro Velez (UP Law Batch '58) |

### Juris Doctor, University of the Philippines College of Law (1998)

The foundation of everything came from the University of the Philippines College of Law, where Velez earned his **Juris Doctor (JD)** in **1998.**

He went on to pass the **Philippine Bar Examinations** in **1999,** joining the rolls of the country's licensed attorneys.

The UP College of Law is widely regarded as the Philippines' most rigorous and prestigious law school, and graduating from it marked Velez as part of an elite tier of Filipino legal practitioners from the very beginning.

### Master in National Security Administration (MNSA), National Defense College of the Philippines (2009)

In **2009,** Velez completed his **Master in National Security Administration (MNSA)** at the National Defense College of the Philippines (NDCP).

The NDCP program is designed for senior civilian officials and military officers, and it covers the full spectrum of national security policy, strategic analysis, and defense management.

Completing it earned Velez a commission as a **Lieutenant Colonel** in the **Philippine Marines**, a remarkable distinction for a civilian lawyer and a credential that few attorneys in the country can claim.

### Master of Arts in Islamic Studies (MAIS), University of the Philippines Diliman

Perhaps the most distinctive credential in his portfolio, Velez completed a **Master of Arts in Islamic Studies (MAIS)** at the University of the Philippines Diliman.

He finished the program with a **General Weighted Average (GWA) of 1.08**, an exceptional academic mark in the Philippine grading scale, where 1.0 represents the highest possible achievement.

This degree gave Velez deep formal training in Islamic theology, jurisprudence, and Shari'ah law, opening a dimension of legal practice that very few Filipino lawyers have ever pursued at the graduate level.

## Career

Velez's career moves in three clear chapters, each with its own stage and its own demands.

### Department of National Defense (2010 to 2015)

From **2010 to 2015,** Velez served as the **Assistant Secretary for Acquisitions, Installations, and Logistics** at the Department of National Defense (DND).

In that role, he was the point person for the **AFP Modernization Program,** a flagship national initiative to upgrade the weapons systems, infrastructure, and logistics of the Armed Forces of the Philippines (AFP).

Managing large-scale defense acquisitions requires a sharp combination of legal, regulatory, and administrative expertise.

Velez brought all of that to the DND, overseeing programs that directly shaped the military's operational capabilities during a period of significant security challenges in the country.

## International Consultancy: United Nations Food and Agriculture Organization

Alongside his domestic government work, Velez also contributed on the international stage as a consultant to the United Nations Food and Agriculture Organization (UN FAO).

His consultancy covered parliamentary expertise and food security, two areas that require a sophisticated understanding of legislative frameworks and international policy processes.

This international engagement added a multilateral dimension to a career that had already spanned defense, law, and academia.

## Co-Founding of Marcoleta Julian Reyes and Velez (MJRV) Law Offices (2015)

In **2015,** Velez co-founded **Marcoleta Julian Reyes and Velez (MJRV) Law Offices,** bringing his extensive government, policy, and national security experience into private legal practice.

The firm allowed him to channel his specialized competencies into client service while maintaining his engagement with bar governance and legal education.

## Professor of Laws, Philippine Law School

Running parallel to his government and private practice work, Velez has also served as a **Professor of Laws** at the **Philippine Law School,** shaping the legal thinking of the next generation of Filipino attorneys.

His lectures draw from an unusually broad experiential base: national defense, Islamic jurisprudence, bar discipline, and international policy.

## National Executive Director, Integrated Bar of the Philippines (October 2025 to present)

Since **October 2025,** Velez has held the post of **National Executive Director** of the Integrated Bar of the Philippines (IBP).

The IBP is the mandatory organization for all licensed lawyers in the Philippines, and its National Executive Director carries responsibility for the institution's day-to-day operations, governance, and delivery of services to tens of thousands of legal practitioners nationwide.

The appointment brings together every strand of Velez's career: his legal expertise, his administrative experience at the DND, his decade-long service as a Bar Discipline Commissioner, and his broader vision for a modern, technology-forward legal profession.

# Institutional Contributions

Velez's contributions to Philippine law extend well beyond his official titles.

## Passage of the Shari'ah Bar Examinations (2024)

In **2024,** Velez passed the **Shari'ah Bar Examinations,** a specialized exam that formally qualifies lawyers to practice in the Philippines' Shari'ah court system.

This placed him among a very small number of Filipino lawyers certified to practice in both the civil court system and Shari'ah courts simultaneously.

The significance of this cannot be overstated: the Philippines has a substantial Muslim population concentrated in the Bangsamoro region, and having lawyers who can operate fluently within both legal systems is essential for meaningful access to justice in Muslim communities.

## Commissioner for Bar Discipline

For close to two decades, Velez has served as a **Commissioner for Bar Discipline** within the IBP's professional responsibility framework.

The role involves overseeing disciplinary proceedings against lawyers who violate ethical standards, a function that is central to maintaining the integrity of the Philippine bar.

His sustained service in this capacity reflects a level of institutional trust that is earned only through consistency, fairness, and deep familiarity with bar regulations.

## Advocacy for Artificial Intelligence in Legal Practice

Velez has been an outspoken advocate for integrating **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** into the Philippine legal profession.

In an institution known for its traditional rhythms and conservative culture, his push for technology adoption positions him as a reform-minded voice within bar leadership.

His advocacy covers using AI to improve legal research, streamline case management, and expand access to legal services, particularly for underserved communities who cannot afford traditional legal representation.

## Bangsamoro and Muslim Community Advocacy

By embracing his Muslim identity as a professional asset and qualifying as a **Shari'ah Counselor,** Velez has established himself as a meaningful advocate for the Bangsamoro community and Muslim Filipinos more broadly.

He works to ensure that Islamic legal perspectives are reflected in national legislation and policy discussions, pushing for an inclusive legal framework that recognizes the rights and traditions of Muslim communities within the Philippine constitutional order.

# Personal Values and Cultural Significance

At his core, Velez is a bridge-builder.

He operates comfortably at the intersection of worlds that don't always speak to each other: national defense, Islamic scholarship, bar governance, international policy, and legal education.

His personal philosophy is disarmingly simple but demanding in practice: excellence is a ladder, and service to the Ummah (community) and the country should go hand in hand.

That philosophy shapes how he moves through every role he occupies.

Whether he's lecturing on national security strategy, advising on policy matters, or guiding the IBP's institutional priorities, Velez carries the identity of a "Sigma Rhoan" throughout: driven by discipline, grounded in peer excellence, and deeply committed to the law as a tool for genuine public service.

His Muslim identity is not peripheral to his legal career; it is integral to it.

As a Shari'ah-qualified attorney, an Islamic studies graduate with honors, and a community advocate for Bangsamoro Filipinos, Velez has shown that a Filipino Muslim lawyer doesn't have to choose between professional ambition and cultural identity.

He can carry both to the highest levels of the nation's legal institutions, and his career is proof of exactly that.

# Legacy

The title "The Renaissance Jurist" was not handed to Patrick Abdulmalik Marban Velez.

He earned it, credential by credential, role by role, and community by community.

Few Filipino lawyers can claim a combination remotely similar to his: a Juris Doctor from UP, a master's degree in national security, a master's in Islamic studies with a near-perfect GWA, a Philippine Marine commission, dual bar qualifications in civil and Shari'ah law, an international consultancy record with the UN, and a top executive appointment at the country's bar association.

Each piece connects to the others.

His national security training informs how he understands institutional governance.

His Islamic scholarship grounds his advocacy for Bangsamoro communities.

His decades of bar discipline service underpins his credibility as IBP Executive Director.

His push for AI adoption reflects a lawyer who has watched the law evolve across three decades and wants to keep it moving forward.

Velez represents a new model of Filipino legal professional: deeply rooted in tradition while genuinely oriented toward the future.

His work as a bridge between Islamic jurisprudence and Philippine civil law may prove to be his most enduring contribution, especially as the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao continues to develop and refine its own legal and governance frameworks.

For Muslim Filipinos who want to pursue careers in the law without setting aside who they are, Velez's story is both a precedent and an aspiration.

## Recognition

- Commission as **Lieutenant Colonel,** Philippine Marines, earned upon completion of the MNSA at the National Defense College of the Philippines (2009)
- Completion of a **Master of Arts in Islamic Studies** at UP Diliman with a **General Weighted Average of 1.08** (among the highest in the Philippine academic grading scale)
- Appointment as **National Executive Director** of the Integrated Bar of the Philippines (October 2025)
- Certification as a **Shari'ah Bar** lawyer, qualifying him to practice before Shari'ah courts (2024)
- Nearly two decades of continuous service as a **Commissioner for Bar Discipline** within the IBP
- International consultancy recognition through engagement with the United Nations Food and Agriculture Organization (UN FAO)

## Challenges

Building a career that spans multiple disciplines is never without friction.

Velez's path has required navigating institutional environments that are not always designed to accommodate someone who moves fluently between national defense, Islamic law, and bar governance.

Being a Muslim Filipino lawyer within institutions predominantly shaped by civil law traditions and non-Muslim cultural norms means consistently having to assert the legitimacy and relevance of Islamic legal perspectives, not just as a cultural matter but as a legal and policy imperative.

Advocating for the integration of Shari'ah principles into national legislation is a long-term project that requires scholarly credibility, diplomatic patience, and sustained engagement with lawmakers, legal academics, and civil society, all of which Velez has worked to build over the course of his career.

His push for AI adoption in the legal profession also places him in the position of a reformer within a traditionally conservative institution.

Driving meaningful technological change in the IBP means persuading a large and diverse membership of the value of tools and practices that many practitioners have never used, a task that calls for the same combination of vision and pragmatism that has defined Velez's career from the start.

## See Also

- Integrated Bar of the Philippines
- Shari'ah courts in the Philippines
- National Defense College of the Philippines
- University of the Philippines College of Law
- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- AFP Modernization Program
- Philippine Bar Examinations

# External Links

- Integrated Bar of the Philippines (Official Facebook Page) (https://www.facebook.com/IntegratedBarPH/)
- University of the Philippines College of Law (Official Website) (https://law.upd.edu.ph/)
- Atty. Patrick Marban Velez (Facebook) (https://www.facebook.com/pm.velez.73/)

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